

Start from a respectful, benign interpretation of an ambiguous action before you ask, correct, or disagree.

- Perception** Something could be read as careless, hostile, resistant, or dismissive.
- Move** Choose a plausible good-faith reason, constraint, or misunderstanding.
- Phrase** “I’m assuming there’s a reasonable reason. Can you walk me through it?”
- Calibration** If they relax or clarify, continue. If impact is minimised, switch to direct impact language.
- Recovery** “I may have softened that too much. The issue is still real.”
- Chain** Follow with clean request, validation without agreement, summary check, or boundary.

Field tip: Start generous; stay precise.